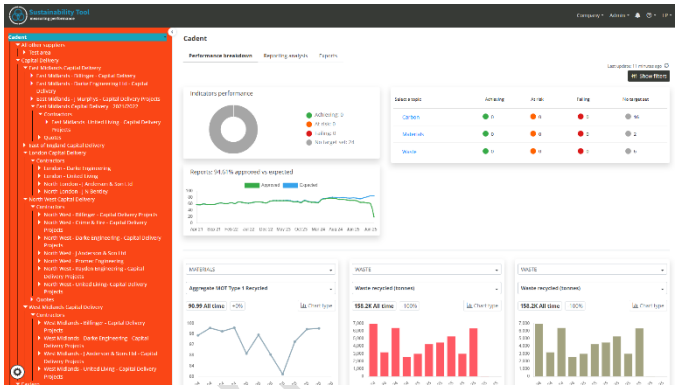
Environment Instruction

ENV/I/12 - Data Assurance for Business Carbon Footprint in Action Sustainability Information for Data Providers and Report Approvers

1. Introduction – Environmental Data Assurance

This instruction supports the assurance of data reported under RIIO-GD2 Table 11.06 – Environment: Business Carbon Footprint. Metrics include total mileage; litres of petrol and litres of diesel used in reinstatement activities for Cadent's Scope 3 emissions.



2. Background – Action Sustainability Tool

At the start of RIIO-2, we partnered with the Supply Chain Sustainability School to further embed sustainability in our business and across our supply chain. With the School's help and the platform provided, we are using the Action Sustainability reporting tool to strengthen sustainability performance and reporting with our supply chain partners.

3. Data Assurance Requirements

Environmental data assurance involves several steps to ensure data accuracy, reliability and consistency. This includes robust data collection, regular data checks and verifying data against source documents and reports.

To support our internal assurance check for Regulatory Reporting (RRP to Ofgem, Table 11.06 Environment: Business Carbon Footprint), we must ensure that data accuracy is sampled and checked for consistency.

4. Examples of Supporting Documentation

The following documentation must be used to support data assurance, but not limited to:

- Fuel Card Invoices
- Fuel Receipts
- Mileage

5. Sampling Methodology

A minimum of 10% of monthly entries must be sampled, ensuring coverage across different contractors and regions. Sampling should be risk-based, prioritising high-volume or high-risk activities from LDPs or other Street works. Data assurance must be on a sample size, and conducted twice a year, as a minimum at year-end (1 April to 31 March) to assure the data for internal and external reporting.

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6. Roles and Responsibilities

Data Reporter

- Enters their company's sustainability performance data into the Action Sustainability tool.
- Uploads documentation to support performance figures for specific metrics.
- Use the 'Reports due' page to manage submissions.

Adding documents

Reporters will be required to upload documentation to support the performance figures entered for specific metrics.

Reporters are able to see a full list of the metrics they are required to report against. If document upload functionality has been requested for a metric, Reporters can see this at the end of the row for the required metric. There is a grey button with 'select file' on it, as well as a bracketed number which references the number of documents required.

To upload a document:

1. Click the 'select file' button at the end of the metric row on the 'Reports due' page. This will bring up a window to your files.
2. Select the file you want to use and click 'upload'. You will then be able to see the file on the 'Reports due' page at the end of the related metric's row. There will be two new buttons, one blue with the word 'upload' and one grey with the word 'clear'.
3. If you are happy with the selected file, click upload. If you have selected the wrong file, click clear and start again from point 1.

The role of the Approver

A data approver is responsible for checking that the data submitted by the reporter is correct (sense-checking) and either approving or rejecting the report submitted.

- Checks submitted data for accuracy and consistency.
- Approves or rejects reports based on quality.
- Should be a sustainability professional within the project or client company.
- If data is rejected more than twice, escalate to the CMO/ Network SHE team. Persistent discrepancies may trigger a deeper investigation.

7. Data Validation Checklist

Approvers should verify:

- Consistency between reported figures and supporting documents
- Correct units (e.g., Litres, Mileage)

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- Completeness of data entries
- Logical trends (e.g., Litres vs. reinstatement activities)

For further information on how to use the Action Sustainability tool, refer to the User Guidance User Guidance — Sustainability Tool 1.5 documentation

Disclaimer

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